BASIC DT TASKS

Paul Silvia, August 2019

Here's a text version of a basic divergent thinking task. It is what we have used in many, many studies. We run the tasks in MediaLab and use a time limit of 3 minutes. It is worth recording response times for each response, if possible. The open-ended responses can then be scored in all manner of ways, ideally with subjective ratings:

> Benedek, M., Mühlmann, C., Jauk, E., & Neubauer, A. C. (2013). Assessment of divergent thinking by means of the subjective top-scoring method: Effects of the number of top-ideas and time-on-task on reliability and validity. *Psychology of Aesthetics, Creativity, and the Arts, 7,* 341-349.
>
> Silvia, P. J., Martin, C., & Nusbaum, E. C. (2009). A snapshot of creativity: Evaluating a quick and simple method for assessing divergent thinking. *Thinking Skills and Creativity, 4,* 79-85.
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> Silvia, P. J., Winterstein, B. P., Willse, J. T., Barona, C. M., Cram, J. T., Hess, K. I., Martinez, J. L., & Richard, C. A. (2008). Assessing creativity with divergent thinking tasks: Exploring the reliability and validity of new subjective scoring methods. *Psychology of Aesthetics, Creativity, and the Arts, 2,* 68-85.

The basic task structure is versatile. You can ask participants to self-rate their responses or to classify them (such as whether a response is one of their best or if it is an "old or new" response), and you can vary the time limits and so on as well. The actual object prompts don't matter too much, but some objects seem more fertile than others. (See Beaty et al.'s paper on DT fan effects: https://psyarxiv.com/pfz2g/).

The instructions are important. Historically, DT research has emphasized quantity by simply asking people to come up with as many responses as possible. Instead, asking participants to focus on creative quality yields much more variability and more valid scores. See here for details:

> Nusbaum, E. C., Silvia, P. J., & Beaty, R. E. (2014). Ready, set, create: What instructing people to "be creative" reveals about the meaning and mechanisms of divergent thinking. *Psychology of Aesthetics, Creativity, and the Arts*, *8*, 423-432.

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CREATIVE USES TASK

For this task, you'll be asked to come up with as many original and creative uses for a BRICK as you can. The goal is to come up with *creative ideas*, which are ideas that strike people as clever, unusual, interesting, uncommon, humorous, innovative, or different.

Your ideas don't have to be practical or realistic; they can be silly or strange, even, so long as they are CREATIVE uses rather than ordinary uses.

You can enter as many ideas as you like; just press ENTER after each one. The task will take 3 minutes. You can type in as many ideas as you like until then, but *creative quality is more important than quantity*. It's better to have a few really good ideas than a lot of uncreative ones.

Please click on "Continue" to begin.

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Please list all of the creative, unusual uses for a BRICK you can think of.

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CREATIVE USES TASK

For this task, you'll be asked to come up with as many original and creative uses for a BOX as you can. The goal is to come up with *creative ideas*, which are ideas that strike people as clever, unusual, interesting, uncommon, humorous, innovative, or different.

Your ideas don't have to be practical or realistic; they can be silly or strange, even, so long as they are CREATIVE uses rather than ordinary uses.

You can enter as many ideas as you like; just press ENTER after each one. The task will take 3 minutes. You can type in as many ideas as you like until then, but *creative quality is more important than quantity*. It's better to have a few really good ideas than a lot of uncreative ones.

Please click on "Continue" to begin.

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Please list all of the creative, unusual uses for a BOX you can think of.